Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: What should you do if a peer critique suggests adding a bold white gouache or pastel highlight rim, and you are unsure how it will react with your ink wash?

Correct: Test that exact ink-plus-highlight combination on your 6 cm swatch card first to check opacity and edge sharpness — Exactly! The swatch card lets you verify how the media react before applying it to your main work.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: How can you quieten a background pattern that has become too loud and busy compared to your central subject? -> Glaze a unified translucent wash lightly over the background or strengthen the tonal contrast and contour on the central subject (Yes! Knocking back the background value or boosting the subject's contrast restores hierarchy.)

Q2: What makes a critique log entry read like an advanced studio practitioner's note? -> Stating the diagnostic issue,

showing the physical swatch test, and explaining how the refinement resolved the visual hierarchy (Spot on. Diagnostic -> Swatch -> Resolution is the complete analytical loop.)

Q3: When mounting your resolved identity piece onto a presentation board at the end of the session, what colour mount works best? -> A neutral dark charcoal, slate, or off-white mount that frames the edges cleanly without competing with your palette (Correct. A disciplined neutral mount locks the composition inside a crisp gallery border.)

Exit check answer

Question: What is the quickest studio method to quieten a busy patterned background that is competing with your central focal point?

Correct: Apply a unifying translucent wash over the background or increase the tonal contrast and contour weight around the focal subject — Correct. Controlling relative tonal value separates foreground from background immediately.